AI Video Bootcamp

AI VIDEO BOOTCAMP

High-Impact Camera Moves Prompt Library

Lesson Support Guide

AI Video Bootcamp

What you're building

A practical camera-move prompt library for directing AI video with intention. Instead of asking for generic movement, each framework gives the model a clear reason to move: realization, scale, threat, geography, emotion, rhythm, or reveal.

30 cinematic camera-move frameworks

Each entry includes:

- Core idea and what changes
- Use cases and shot/lens guidance
- Safer version for cleaner AI outputs
- Risks to avoid messy movement
- Prompt template, example, and short add-on line

Use this as a director's reference: choose the camera move first, then adapt the template to your scene, subject, lighting, pacing, and emotional trigger.

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F1

Slow Motivated Push-In

The camera begins to move at the exact moment of realization, decision, threat detection, or internal change.

Shot: Medium, Medium Close-Up, Close-Up · Lens: 50mm, 65mm, 75mm

What changes

The camera begins to move at the exact moment of realization, decision, threat detection, or internal change.

Use cases

Realization, decision, threat, emotional shift.

Safer version

Use a short, straight push-in with a clear trigger and a locked final frame.

Risks

If there is no trigger, the move becomes generic drift. Too long a push-in can become mushy or slow-motion-like.

Prompt template

Begin on [Frame A]. After [trigger], start a slow physical dolly in toward [subject]. Keep the move subtle and motivated, with controlled ease-in, gentle momentum build, and a precise ease-out into [Frame B]. Real-time action, no slow motion.

Example

Locked-off medium shot of a woman in a quiet kitchen. After she notices the knife missing from the counter, begin a slow physical dolly in toward her face. Subtle ease-in, gentle build of momentum, real-time movement, ending in a locked close-up as fear becomes visible in her expression.

Short add-on line: Begin on [Frame A].

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F2

Pull-Out Scale Reveal

The shot begins tight, then expands outward to reveal the true scale of the world, danger, crowd, architecture, or environment.

Shot: Close-Up to Wide, Medium to Extreme Wide · Lens: 24mm, 28mm, 35mm

What changes

The shot begins tight, then expands outward to reveal the true scale of the world, danger, crowd, architecture, or environment.

Use cases

Scale, consequence, geography, surprise.

Safer version

Start with one clear subject and reveal one major layer of information.

Risks

If the reveal is vague, the move loses purpose. If the environment is underdescribed, the reveal feels empty.

Prompt template

Begin tight on [subject/detail]. Perform a smooth dolly out or crane out to reveal [environment/scale]. Preserve real perspective change, layered depth, and a readable final wide frame. End with a stable hold on the revealed world.

Example

Begin on a close-up of a firefighter's soot-covered face inside a dark hallway. Perform a smooth dolly out to reveal that he is standing inside a vast burning hotel atrium filled with smoke, falling debris, and panicked civilians. Maintain real perspective change and end in a readable wide composition that lands on the full scale of the emergency.

Short add-on line: Begin tight on [subject/detail].

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F3

Layered Parallax Push-In

The camera pushes toward the subject through close foreground layers, creating depth, voyeurism, and physical entry into the scene.

Shot: Medium Wide, Medium, Medium Close-Up · Lens: 24mm, 28mm, 35mm

What changes

The camera pushes toward the subject through close foreground layers, creating depth, voyeurism, and physical entry into the scene.

Use cases

Depth, immersion, surveillance feeling, physical presence.

Safer version

Use one or two clear foreground layers only: doorframe, glass, fabric, plants, shoulder.

Risks

Too many foreground layers can create clutter. Long lenses reduce the effect. Weak foreground kills the parallax.

Prompt template

Push in toward [subject] through close foreground elements such as [foreground list]. Emphasize layered depth and near-field parallax. The camera should physically travel through space, not digitally zoom. End with a cleaner, closer frame on the subject.

Example

Push in toward a detective standing in a dim archive room through a blurred foreground of hanging plastic sheets and filing shelves. Emphasize layered depth, strong near-field parallax, and the feeling of physically entering the space. The camera travels through the room and ends in a tighter medium close-up on the detective as he finds the hidden file.

Short add-on line: Push in toward [subject] through close foreground elements such as [foreground list].

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F4

Meaning-Changing Arc / Orbit

As the camera arcs around the subject, the meaning of the shot changes because the background, light, power dynamic, or information changes.

Shot: Medium Wide, Medium · Lens: 35mm, 40mm, 50mm

What changes

As the camera arcs around the subject, the meaning of the shot changes because the background, light, power dynamic, or information changes.

Use cases

Reveal threat, shift power, expose new information, emotional reversal.

Safer version

Use a 90 to 180 degree arc for beginners instead of a full 360 orbit.

Risks

Full 360 orbits are risky for identity and geometry. If nothing changes during the move, the orbit becomes

Prompt template

Arc around [subject] through approximately [90-180] degrees. During the move, reveal a meaningful change in [background/light/power/information]. Keep the path controlled and readable. End on a new angle that changes the interpretation of the scene.

Example

Arc around a politician delivering a calm speech on stage through 120 degrees. As the camera moves, reveal the aggressive protesters and flashing police lights behind him, transforming the moment from confidence to danger. Keep the movement controlled and end on a new angle that completely changes the meaning of the scene.

Short add-on line: Arc around [subject] through approximately [90-180] degrees.

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F5

Crane From Character To World

The camera starts near the character and rises outward into a larger environment, expanding the story from personal to global.

Shot: Medium, Full, Wide · Lens: 24mm, 28mm, 35mm

What changes

The camera starts near the character and rises outward into a larger environment, expanding the story from personal to global.

Use cases

Scale, consequences, endings, emotional expansion.

Safer version

Start close enough to establish intimacy, then reveal one clear world-scale payoff.

Risks

If the top frame is not clearly designed, the move feels empty. If the rise is too fast, the shot becomes

Prompt template

Start close to [character] at [shot size], then perform a controlled crane up and out to reveal [world/aftermath/environment]. Preserve the emotional connection at the start and expand into a large-scale final frame with a stable landing.

Example

Start beside a lone medic kneeling in the mud beside a wounded soldier. Perform a controlled crane up and out to reveal the full flooded battlefield, burning vehicles, and hundreds of retreating troops around them. Preserve the intimacy of the first moment, then expand into a large-scale final frame that lands clearly on the wider consequence.

Short add-on line: Start close to [character] at [shot size], then perform a controlled crane up and out to reveal [world/aftermath/environment].

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F6

Top-Down Graphic Tracking

A strict overhead camera tracks along a route, turning people, vehicles, or objects into graphic shapes inside a system.

Shot: Top-Down Wide or Medium Wide · Lens: 24mm, 28mm, 35mm equivalent overhead

What changes

A strict overhead camera tracks along a route, turning people, vehicles, or objects into graphic shapes inside a system.

Use cases

Geography, routes, systems, stylization, tactical clarity.

Safer version

Keep the route simple and readable. Use strong shapes and clean separation.

Risks

Messy production design or unclear paths reduce the graphic effect. Too much tilt breaks the top-down logic.

Prompt template

Use a strict top-down camera. Track above [subject/path/system] as it moves through [space]. Emphasize graphic clarity, route readability, and the transformation of people or vehicles into visual shapes. Maintain consistent overhead orientation throughout.

Example

Use a strict top-down camera tracking above a courier running across a maze-like market rooftop route marked by colored tarps and narrow bridges. Emphasize route readability, repeating geometric shapes, and clear overhead orientation while the environment becomes a graphic map of movement.

Short add-on line: Use a strict top-down camera.

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F7

Whip-Pan Reveal / Match Cut

A rapid pan reveals new information or hides a transition between two connected shots.

Shot: Any shot size, safest in Medium and Wide · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

A rapid pan reveals new information or hides a transition between two connected shots.

Use cases

Rhythm, comedy, action punctuation, hidden cut.

Safer version

Match direction, blur density, and brightness if using it as a hidden cut.

Risks

If the exit and entry blur do not match, the cut reads. Too much content during the blur creates noise.

Prompt template

Execute a fast whip pan from [start subject/direction] to [new subject/information]. If used as a transition, let the frame enter full motion blur, then continue the same blur into the next shot before revealing the new scene. Keep the movement aggressive and readable.

Example

Whip pan quickly from a chef shouting in a crowded kitchen to the dining room as a fire erupts near the bar. Let the frame enter full horizontal motion blur, then continue the same blur into the next view so the reveal lands as both a new piece of information and a seamless action accent.

Short add-on line: Execute a fast whip pan from [start subject/direction] to [new subject/information].

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F8

Dolly Zoom

The subject remains approximately the same size while the space around them changes geometry.

Shot: Medium, Medium Close-Up, Full · Lens: 24mm to 70mm equivalent combination

What changes

The subject remains approximately the same size while the space around them changes geometry.

Use cases

Shock, alienation, realization, power shift.

Safer version

Use one clean subject and a strong background with visible depth layers.

Risks

Weak background depth makes the effect unclear. AI may replace the move with a simple zoom if the physical dolly is

Prompt template

Maintain [subject] at approximately the same frame size while combining a physical dolly [in/out] with an opposing zoom [out/in]. Emphasize changing spatial geometry and preserved subject scale. End on a psychologically altered view of the space.

Example

Keep a frightened bride at roughly the same medium-close framing while performing a physical dolly in combined with a zoom out. The cathedral behind her stretches and warps in perspective, creating a strong feeling of shock and disorientation as she realizes the groom never arrived.

Short add-on line: Maintain [subject] at approximately the same frame size while combining a physical dolly [in/out] with an opposing zoom [out/in].

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F9

Elastic Wide-Close-Wide

The shot moves from space to person and back to space, expanding and contracting narrative attention in one sequence.

Shot: Wide to Close to Wide · Lens: 24mm, 35mm

What changes

The shot moves from space to person and back to space, expanding and contracting narrative attention in one sequence.

Use cases

Context, reaction, consequence.

Safer version

Keep the route readable and the emotional center clear.

Risks

If the center beat is weak, the structure feels mechanical. Too much camera complexity can make the middle

Prompt template

Begin with a wide view of [environment]. Move inward toward [character/reaction] for an intimate central beat, then expand back out to reveal [consequence/world]. Keep the transition continuous and emotionally motivated.

Example

Begin with a wide view of a flooded subway platform crowded with stranded commuters. Move inward toward a teenage boy as he realizes his little sister is missing, then expand back out to reveal the full panic spreading through the station as the water level rises.

Short add-on line: Begin with a wide view of [environment].

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F10

Camera Leaves The Hero

The camera begins with the hero but then abandons them to reveal consequences, threat, another character, or a more important space.

Shot: Medium, Wide, Tracking shots · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The camera begins with the hero but then abandons them to reveal consequences, threat, another character, or a more important space.

Use cases

Consequences, dramatic irony, re-prioritization.

Safer version

Make the second destination clearly more important than the hero.

Risks

If the camera leaves without revealing something meaningful, the move feels arbitrary.

Prompt template

Track with [hero] initially, then deliberately leave them and continue toward [consequence/threat/other character/key detail/independent space]. The move should clearly reassign narrative importance away from the hero.

Example

Track with a boxer leaving the locker room toward the arena entrance, then let the camera abandon him and continue toward his young son watching nervously from the tunnel shadows. The move should clearly shift emotional importance away from the fighter and toward the child.

Short add-on line: Track with [hero] initially, then deliberately leave them and continue toward [consequence/threat/other character/key detail/independent space].

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F11

Moving Master Through Several Beats

One continuous shot replaces several separate setups by carrying the scene through geography, dialogue, reaction, and reframe.

Shot: Wide to Medium to Close combinations · Lens: 28mm, 35mm, 40mm

What changes

One continuous shot replaces several separate setups by carrying the scene through geography, dialogue, reaction, and reframe.

Use cases

Scene coverage without cuts, performance continuity, blocking-led storytelling.

Safer version

Build around three or four clear beats, not ten.

Risks

Too many beats create confusion. Weak blocking makes the shot feel like wandering.

Prompt template

Design one continuous moving master that covers several story beats without cutting: [wide geography], [interaction], [reaction], [closer emphasis]. Let camera movement and blocking reframe the scene naturally through each beat.

Example

Design one continuous moving master inside a tense family dinner: begin wide to establish the table and all five relatives, move closer as the father questions the eldest son, drift into a two-shot for the mother's intervention, then land in a close-up as the son finally confesses the truth.

Short add-on line: Design one continuous moving master that covers several story beats without cutting: [wide geography], [interaction], [reaction], [closer emphasis].

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F12

Foreground Occlusion Transition

A close foreground object fully covers the frame and reveals a new shot, time, or location.

Shot: Any size, safest in Medium and Wide · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

A close foreground object fully covers the frame and reveals a new shot, time, or location.

Use cases

Hidden transitions, continuity, AI consistency.

Safer version

Use a full, readable occlusion that temporarily removes visual information.

Risks

Partial occlusion often fails as a hidden cut. The cover object must dominate the frame.

Prompt template

Let a close foreground object fully cover the lens, creating complete visual occlusion. Use that occlusion point to transition into [new scene/time/location], then clear the frame to reveal the next shot. Preserve directional continuity if needed.

Example

Follow a woman through a busy train station until a dark coat passes extremely close to the lens and fully covers the frame. Use that total occlusion to transition into the same woman emerging years later from a subway exit in a different city, then clear the frame to reveal the new location.

Short add-on line: Let a close foreground object fully cover the lens, creating complete visual occlusion.

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F13

Rig Pass-Off

The shot transitions from one rig logic to another without a visible cut, allowing a path impossible for a single rig.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide · Lens: 24mm, 28mm, 35mm

What changes

The shot transitions from one rig logic to another without a visible cut, allowing a path impossible for a single rig.

Use cases

Continuous spectacle, impossible but believable coverage.

Safer version

Limit the pass-off chain to two or three rigs for clarity.

Risks

Too many pass-offs become confusing. The handoff moment must be motivated by proximity, occlusion, or path

Prompt template

Create one continuous shot that hands the camera path off between rig modes: [rig 1] to [rig 2] to [rig 3]. Preserve path continuity and spatial logic so the transition feels seamless rather than random.

Example

Create one continuous shot that begins on a crane rising over a rally car launch, hands off into handheld beside the driver as he exits the vehicle, then passes into a drone as he runs toward the cliff edge. Preserve the path continuity so the sequence feels like one impossible but readable move.

Short add-on line: Create one continuous shot that hands the camera path off between rig modes: [rig 1] to [rig 2] to [rig 3].

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F14

Reactive Handheld Snap Zoom

A reactive handheld camera responds to a sudden event with slight human delay, fast pan, snap zoom, brief blur, correction, and settle.

Shot: Medium, Wide, Action Medium Close-Up · Lens: 35mm, 50mm, zoom-capable doc style

What changes

A reactive handheld camera responds to a sudden event with slight human delay, fast pan, snap zoom, brief blur, correction, and settle.

Use cases

Documentary presence, chaos, adrenaline, grounding digital action.

Safer version

Use one clean reaction chain: event, delay, pan, snap zoom, correction, settle.

Risks

Continuous shaking ruins the effect. The human delay and corrective reframing are essential.

Prompt template

Use a reactive handheld documentary camera inside [scene]. The operator follows [subject/event] with slight human delay, briefly loses perfect framing, then performs an abrupt snap zoom toward [target]. Include controlled handheld shake, rapid corrective reframing, brief motion smear during the zoom, subtle focus correction, heavy physical inertia, and a final settle instead of a weightless float.

Example

Reactive handheld documentary camera inside a fully digital action scene. The operator follows the fast-moving creature with slight human delay, briefly loses perfect framing, then performs an abrupt snap zoom toward its face as it suddenly turns. Controlled handheld shake, rapid corrective reframing, brief motion smear during the zoom, subtle focus correction, heavy physical inertia. The camera settles after the reaction instead of floating smoothly.

Short add-on line: Use a reactive handheld documentary camera inside [scene].

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F15

Impossible Macro-To-World Transition

The camera begins inside an extreme microscopic or internal detail and emerges into a much larger world.

Shot: Macro to Wide · Lens: Macro equivalent to 24-35mm world exit

What changes

The camera begins inside an extreme microscopic or internal detail and emerges into a much larger world.

Use cases

Scale shock, conceptual transitions, surreal science or fantasy.

Safer version

Choose one clear micro starting point and one clear world payoff.

Risks

If the spatial transformation is vague, the viewer loses the connection between micro and macro worlds.

Prompt template

Begin inside an extreme macro view of [eye/cell/tissue/crack/mechanism/drop]. Travel outward in one continuous move until the camera exits into a full-scale [world/environment/scene]. Preserve a clear visual link between the micro origin and the revealed world.

Example

Begin inside the iris texture of a terrified human eye, then travel outward through reflected moisture and skin detail until the camera exits into a full-scale riot scene reflected in that eye. Preserve a clear spatial connection between the microscopic beginning and the revealed public chaos.

Short add-on line: Begin inside an extreme macro view of [eye/cell/tissue/crack/mechanism/drop].

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F16

Vehicle-To-Character Handoff

The camera begins attached to a vehicle or mechanism, then detaches and continues with the character.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide, Medium · Lens: 24mm, 28mm, 35mm

What changes

The camera begins attached to a vehicle or mechanism, then detaches and continues with the character.

Use cases

Transition from mechanics to emotion, speed to reaction.

Safer version

Make the detachment point obvious and motivated by the hero's movement.

Risks

If the handoff is unclear, the move feels like a teleport. Maintain direction and speed continuity.

Prompt template

Begin attached to [vehicle/mechanism], moving with its physical motion. At the key moment, detach from the machine and continue following [character], preserving directional continuity and shifting emphasis from mechanical motion to human reaction.

Example

Begin mounted to the hood of a racing truck as it crashes through a barricade, then detach from the vehicle and continue following the driver as she jumps out and runs through the dust. Preserve speed and direction continuity while shifting emphasis from machine physics to the driver's emotional urgency.

Short add-on line: Begin attached to [vehicle/mechanism], moving with its physical motion.

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F17

Ground-Level Vehicle Hard-Mount

The camera is mounted very low near the wheel, bumper, chassis, or suspension to emphasize speed, vibration, and danger.

Shot: Wide, Extreme low-angle mounted · Lens: 18mm, 24mm

What changes

The camera is mounted very low near the wheel, bumper, chassis, or suspension to emphasize speed, vibration, and danger.

Use cases

Velocity, mass, aggression, road contact.

Safer version

Stay close to one physical vehicle surface and let the world race by.

Risks

If the mount point is vague, the shot may float. Excessive distortion can look game-like if not grounded.

Prompt template

Use a hard-mounted ground-level camera positioned near the [wheel/bumper/underside/suspension] of [vehicle]. Emphasize vibration, mass, speed, and dangerous proximity to the road surface. Keep the camera rigidly attached to the vehicle.

Example

Use a hard-mounted ground-level camera near the front wheel and lower bumper of a rally car tearing across a wet mountain road. Emphasize rigid attachment, heavy vibration, water spray, dangerous proximity to the asphalt, and the violent speed of the passing terrain.

Short add-on line: Use a hard-mounted ground-level camera positioned near the [wheel/bumper/underside/suspension] of [vehicle].

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F18

Bullet Time / Time-Slice Orbit

The action freezes or nearly freezes while the camera continues moving around a critical instant.

Shot: Medium, Full, Wide · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The action freezes or nearly freezes while the camera continues moving around a critical instant.

Use cases

Study impact, spatial relation, iconic action beat.

Safer version

Choose one decisive instant: jump, punch, crash, collision.

Risks

Without a strong frozen action beat, the move becomes a gimmick. Keep the orbit readable.

Prompt template

Freeze or nearly freeze the action at the decisive instant of [event]. Continue moving the camera around the moment in a controlled arc or orbit, preserving spatial relationships while separating camera time from subject time.

Example

Freeze the exact instant a martial artist's kick lands on the attacker's jaw, then continue moving the camera in a smooth 140-degree orbit around the suspended action. Preserve the spatial relationship between both bodies and use the move to study the impact from multiple angles while time remains frozen.

Short add-on line: Freeze or nearly freeze the action at the decisive instant of [event].

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F19

Environment-Triggered Camera Reaction

The environment hits the camera after a force travels through space; the camera reacts only when the force physically reaches it.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide, Documentary-style Medium · Lens: 24mm, 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The environment hits the camera after a force travels through space; the camera reacts only when the force physically reaches it.

Use cases

Explosions, giant steps, waves, collisions, turbulence.

Safer version

Always stage the event first, then the traveling force, then the camera reaction.

Risks

If the camera reacts before the force arrives, the physics feel fake.

Prompt template

Stage [environmental event] first. Let the physical force travel through the environment, and only when it reaches the camera should the frame jolt, sway, or recover. Preserve cause and effect: event first, camera reaction second.

Example

A giant creature slams its foot into the street several meters away. Dust, debris, and a visible shockwave travel toward the camera. Only when that force reaches the lens does the frame jolt sideways, tremble, and recover. Preserve strict physical cause and effect.

Short add-on line: Stage [environmental event] first.

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F20

Low-To-High Stabilized Reveal

The camera starts near the floor or a low object, travels upward, and reveals the face or larger space.

Shot: Low to Medium / Wide · Lens: 24mm, 35mm

What changes

The camera starts near the floor or a low object, travels upward, and reveals the face or larger space.

Use cases

Elegant reveal, power, discovery, product or character entrance.

Safer version

Use one clear low anchor point and one clear reveal destination.

Risks

If the low start is generic, the reveal loses shape. Too much tilt can break the clean rise.

Prompt template

Begin with a stabilized camera near the floor or low object, then travel forward and rise upward to reveal [face/subject/space]. Keep the path smooth, controlled, and readable, with a designed landing on the reveal.

Example

Begin with a stabilized camera skimming just above polished marble tiles and passing a fallen chess piece, then rise smoothly toward the queen standing at the end of the hall. End in a medium shot that reveals her expression and the vast throne room behind her.

Short add-on line: Begin with a stabilized camera near the floor or low object, then travel forward and rise upward to reveal [face/subject/space].

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F21

Time-Layer Pass

The camera passes behind an object and the world changes in time, era, weather, age, or condition.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide, Medium · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The camera passes behind an object and the world changes in time, era, weather, age, or condition.

Use cases

Time transitions, before/after reveals, transformation.

Safer version

Use one strong foreground pass point and one major time change.

Risks

If too many variables change at once, the transformation becomes muddy. The pass object must clearly hide the

Prompt template

Move the camera behind [foreground object]. During the hidden pass, transform [era/time of day/character age/building condition/weather/occupancy]. Clear the foreground to reveal the same path continuing through a changed world.

Example

Track through an abandoned school hallway and pass behind a wide concrete column. During the hidden pass, transform the hallway into the same school thirty years earlier, filled with students, warm sunlight, and fresh paint. Clear the column to reveal the time-shifted world as the movement continues.

Short add-on line: Move the camera behind [foreground object].

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F22

Creature / Gravity Roll

The camera rolls across floor, wall, and ceiling, as if sharing the impossible orientation of a creature or disturbed gravity.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide · Lens: 18mm, 24mm, 28mm

What changes

The camera rolls across floor, wall, and ceiling, as if sharing the impossible orientation of a creature or disturbed gravity.

Use cases

Creature POV, disorientation, impossible physics, psychological break.

Safer version

Keep the environment readable so the roll has a reference frame.

Risks

If the environment lacks clear geometry, the roll loses impact. Too much chaos can become unreadable.

Prompt template

Move the camera with a gravity-defying roll across [floor/wall/ceiling], as if sharing the orientation of [creature/altered gravity state]. Preserve clear environmental geometry so the impossible rotation remains readable.

Example

Follow a spider-like creature as the camera shares its orientation, rolling from the corridor floor up the wall and across the ceiling while chasing a fleeing scientist. Preserve the geometry of the hallway so the impossible movement remains legible and disturbing.

Short add-on line: Move the camera with a gravity-defying roll across [floor/wall/ceiling], as if sharing the orientation of [creature/altered gravity state].

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F23

Focus-Led Move

Attention shifts first through focus, then the camera physically moves toward the newly important subject.

Shot: Medium, Medium Close-Up, Close-Up · Lens: 50mm, 75mm

What changes

Attention shifts first through focus, then the camera physically moves toward the newly important subject.

Use cases

Redirect attention cleanly before changing viewer position.

Safer version

Keep the focus shift readable before the camera begins moving.

Risks

If focus and movement happen at the same instant, the cue can feel muddy. The first object must be clearly

Prompt template

Begin with focus on [initial object/subject]. Shift focus to [new object/subject] first, then begin a camera move toward it. Use focus to direct attention before changing the viewer's position in space.

Example

Begin focused on a wedding ring in the foreground on a hotel sink. Shift focus to the bride standing blurred in the mirror behind it. Only after the focus lands on her, begin a slow push-in toward the mirror image, using the focus shift to redirect attention before the camera moves.

Short add-on line: Begin with focus on [initial object/subject].

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F24

Reaction-Led Push-In

A character notices something off screen; the camera pushes into their reaction before revealing the cause.

Shot: Medium to Close-Up · Lens: 50mm, 65mm, 75mm

What changes

A character notices something off screen; the camera pushes into their reaction before revealing the cause.

Use cases

Suspense, Spielberg-style reveal logic, emotional prioritization.

Safer version

Keep the unseen object off screen during the push-in.

Risks

If the object is shown too soon, the reaction loses priority.

Prompt template

Let [character] notice something off screen. Do not reveal the object yet. First, push in toward the character's reaction and let the emotional response become the key information. Reveal the off-screen cause later or in another shot.

Example

A child hears heavy footsteps outside the bedroom door and looks up. Do not reveal the source yet. First, push in toward the child's face as fear overtakes the expression. Keep the unseen threat off screen so the reaction becomes the primary information in the shot.

Short add-on line: Let [character] notice something off screen.

AI Video Bootcamp

F25

Environment-First Slow Advance

The camera advances slowly through a large space without adjusting itself to the characters.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide · Lens: 35mm, 50mm, 85mm

What changes

The camera advances slowly through a large space without adjusting itself to the characters.

Use cases

Monumentality, indifference, world-first storytelling.

Safer version

Keep the path committed to the space, not to the people.

Risks

If the camera starts correcting to follow characters, the concept is lost.

Prompt template

Move the camera in a slow, committed advance through [environment]. Let characters cross the frame, become smaller, or drift out of focus without the camera adjusting to preserve them. The space itself remains the primary subject.

Example

Move the camera in a slow, committed advance through a colossal desert temple interior. Let the small human figures cross the frame and disappear behind pillars without any reframing. The architecture and the indifferent scale of the environment remain the true subject of the shot.

Short add-on line: Move the camera in a slow, committed advance through [environment].

AI Video Bootcamp

F26

Blocking-Driven Invisible Reframe

Camera and subject movement work together so the shot naturally transforms from wide to medium to close-up without calling attention to itself.

Shot: Wide to Close · Lens: 35mm, 40mm, 50mm

What changes

Camera and subject movement work together so the shot naturally transforms from wide to medium to close-up without calling attention to itself.

Use cases

Invisible sophistication, dialogue scenes, tension growth.

Safer version

Use simple blocking and a single continuous intention.

Risks

If either the camera or actors move without coordination, the shot feels random.

Prompt template

Coordinate camera movement and subject blocking so the shot naturally reframes from [wide] to [medium] to [close-up] without a visible cut. The reframing should emerge from movement inside the scene rather than overt stylistic display.

Example

Inside a tense hospital corridor scene, begin wide with two doctors arguing near opposite ends of the hallway. As one doctor steps forward and the camera subtly tracks sideways and inward, the composition naturally becomes a medium two-shot, then lands in a close-up on the doctor who finally admits the patient is dying.

Short add-on line: Coordinate camera movement and subject blocking so the shot naturally reframes from [wide] to [medium] to [close-up] without a visible cut.

AI Video Bootcamp

F27

Probe / Snorkel Fly-Through

The camera glides through narrow gaps, textures, or machine interiors as if it were a probe entering inaccessible space.

Shot: Macro, Medium, transition shot · Lens: Macro equivalent, 18-35mm depending on scale

What changes

The camera glides through narrow gaps, textures, or machine interiors as if it were a probe entering inaccessible space.

Use cases

Technical wonder, tactile exploration, impossible access.

Safer version

Use one clear entry point and one clear exit destination.

Risks

If the path is vague, the move becomes abstract noise. Texture-rich spaces help.

Prompt template

Let the camera behave like a probe or snorkel lens. Glide through a very narrow gap or along a dense texture, enter [device/material/space], and emerge into [next chamber/full scene]. Preserve the feeling of impossible but continuous access.

Example

Let the camera behave like a probe gliding between the cooling fins of a massive server, slipping through a narrow vent and into the machine's illuminated internal circuitry, then emerging into a full-scale data-center room filled with technicians and pulsing lights.

Short add-on line: Let the camera behave like a probe or snorkel lens.

AI Video Bootcamp

F28

Motion-Control Timeline Change

The same exact camera path repeats while time, character, light, or space changes around it.

Shot: Wide, Medium Wide, Medium · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The same exact camera path repeats while time, character, light, or space changes around it.

Use cases

Before/after, growth, decay, repeated memory, controlled comparison.

Safer version

Keep the path precisely repeatable and the changes clearly legible.

Risks

If the path drifts between passes, the effect weakens. Too many changed variables can feel noisy.

Prompt template

Repeat the exact same camera path with motion-control precision while changing [time/character/state of space/era/light/destruction]. The comparison should come from environmental and narrative change, not from a new camera route.

Example

Repeat the exact same hallway tracking path three times: once when the office is clean and busy in the morning, again at sunset with only one exhausted worker left, and finally years later as the same corridor stands abandoned and decayed. Keep the path identical so the time change becomes the subject.

Short add-on line: Repeat the exact same camera path with motion-control precision while changing [time/character/state of space/era/light/destruction].

AI Video Bootcamp

F29

Static-To-Handheld State Change

The shot begins controlled and stable, then becomes handheld after a loss of control, fear, or violent disruption.

Shot: Any size, safest in Medium / Wide · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The shot begins controlled and stable, then becomes handheld after a loss of control, fear, or violent disruption.

Use cases

Escalation, panic, realism, state shift.

Safer version

Define the exact event that changes the camera state.

Risks

If the switch has no trigger, it feels stylistic rather than dramatic. Handheld should react to the event, not start

Prompt template

Begin the shot in a stable controlled mode such as locked-off or stabilized. After [loss-of-control event], shift the camera into a handheld response with human instability, preserving cause and effect. The state change itself should be the dramatic beat.

Example

Begin on a perfectly stabilized shot of a bride waiting at the altar. The moment the groom collapses in front of the guests, shift the camera into a handheld response with visible human instability and urgency. The loss of camera control should directly follow the loss of control inside the scene.

Short add-on line: Begin the shot in a stable controlled mode such as locked-off or stabilized.

AI Video Bootcamp

F30

Anticipatory Arrival

The camera arrives at the destination before the character or event and waits there.

Shot: Wide, Medium, doorway/corridor/reveal shots · Lens: 35mm, 50mm

What changes

The camera arrives at the destination before the character or event and waits there.

Use cases

Predestination, threat, control, camera knows more than the hero.

Safer version

Choose a destination that carries suspense while empty.

Risks

If the destination is visually uninteresting, the anticipation weakens. The waiting beat matters.

Prompt template

Move the camera to [destination] before [character/event] arrives. Let the camera reach the point first, settle, and wait in a controlled composition. The suspense comes from the empty space becoming charged before the arrival.

Example

Leave the woman in the corridor and let the camera move ahead to an empty nursery doorway. Arrive first, settle into a still composition, and wait. Only then does a shadowy figure enter the room from the other side, turning the previously empty frame into a threatening reveal.

Short add-on line: Move the camera to [destination] before [character/event] arrives.